

March 2025

Seniors United Now

1st Quarter 2025

Issue 64

SUNBURST

The Newsletter for Seniors United Now

Sherwood Business Center – Park Centre Hotel

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The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

Notice is hereby given that the

Annual General Meeting of

Alberta Seniors United Now Society

will be held as follows:

Wednesday April 16, 2025

Santa Maria Goretti Centre

11050-90 Street NW

Edmonton, Alberta

Doors open for Attendance 9:30 am

Meeting Commences 10:00 am

Special Presentation 11:00 am

Luncheon to follow presentations

PRE-REGISTRATION IS REQUIRED

Registration deadline April 04, 2025

Luncheon is included with Registration Fee

SUN is Pleased to Present:

Join Bob Layton and Shane Blakely to hear and see funny, bizarre, and even sad stories from behind the microphone and high in the sky—things you may not have known about the wild world of broadcasting.

Contents

President	2
Executive Director	3
Board of Directors	2
Membership Coordinator	14

Chapter News

Edmonton South	4
Edmonton North	7
Sherwood Park / Strathcona County	
SPSC	8 & 9

Membership

Cash Raffle Winner	9
Belair direct – member benefit	13
It's a chili Day - Cash Raffle	15
Renewal / Donation Form	15
AGM Registration	16

Special Interest / Articles

AGM – Nominating	3
Advocacy	5
AB seniors discounts	5 & 6
Senior Foot Care	10
Except of Letter- Auditor General	11
Friends of Medicare	
Health care system isn't broken	12
New Membership Drive	13
Casino Volunteers	14

Presidents Report

This new year certainly brings forward some issues that may have an effect on Alberta Seniors. Recently we received correspondence from Todd Mann, CEO of the Local Authority Pension Plan. In his letter he states, “the Sponsor Board decided not to offer a cost-of-living enhancement in 2025, aiming to maintain surplus funds during this period of economic uncertainty. As a result, the Cost-of-Living Adjustment effective January 1, 2025, will be at 60% of the increase of the Alberta Consumer Price Index”. However, please be aware that SUN will be corresponding again with Mr. Todd Mann at the end of 2025 to request a Cost-of-Living Adjustment increase to 100% of the consumer price index to take effect January 1, 2026. This request may depend on the success of newly appointed CEO of the Alberta Investment Management Corporation, past Prime Minister Stephen Harper. The reason for his appointment is because of previous concerns over poor management performance and huge increases in administration costs.

On January 8, 2025, the SUN Board sent a letter to Mr. W. Doug Wylie, Auditor General of Alberta, requesting them to consider auditing the Local Authority Pension Plan and the Public Service Pension Plan specifically related to the Coordinated Pension Option. This option has been an ongoing concern to pension retirees. Additional information regarding this letter is included on page 11 of this SUNBURST publication.

Regarding recent events it is interesting to note that our Alberta Premier has decided not to release results of an Alberta public survey on the proposed Alberta Pension Plan. However, she is still focused on promoting the development of this Plan.

The U.S.A. trade tariffs against Canada will certainly have a harmful impact on our economy. We can anticipate an increase in our cost of living for several items, particularly the cost of groceries. Many seniors might have to take a more frugal approach when making purchases and consider supporting products made in Canada.

You may have noticed, members did not receive a hard copy of our previous SUNBURST edition #63 December 2024. A decision was made by the Board of Directors at the December 04, 2024, Board meeting, to only produce an Eversion of SUNBURST 63, along with a limited number of hardcopies. That decision was a direct result of the Canada Post strike and the delays in the mailing system. The Eversion is currently available for viewing on the SUN website and we still have hardcopies available for pick-up at the SUN office and copies were also available at the chapter meetings in January. SUN is dealing with a massive increase in the cost of postage for our SUNBURST newsletters, we encourage members to choose the eversion. More details on these costs will be shared with members in the next edition. To change to the eversion contact our SUN administration via email at unitenow@telus.net

To end on a positive note, we are looking forward to our April 16, 2025, Annual General Meeting and our Casino Fundraising event that will take place toward the end of 2025.

I always appreciate the opportunity to keep you informed of senior issues and look forward to meeting you personally at our AGM.

Sincerely,
Wayne Sorenson, President

SUN Board of Directors 2024 – 2025

Wayne Sorenson - President Stan Poznanski - Vice-President William Holtz - Treasurer
Gloria Krenbrenk – Secretary Robert Price - Director Gerald Northam - Director
Frances Burkitt - Director Rita DeLongchamp-Osborne - Director

SUN Staff

Linda Osborne - Executive Director Lynn Penner - Office Admin Deborah Wilson - Membership Coordinator

Executive Director Report

Well, the resiliency of Alberta residents has really been tested these past couple months, keeping warm was the challenge of the day. But now we are headed into March and things are looking brighter. On February 10, 2025, SUN hosted a virtual presentation with our guest Chris Galloway, Executive Director of Friends of Medicare. Chris' presentation involved a slide presentation on the restructuring of our healthcare system, its governance and changes to many services and programs presently being delivered. We had a strong attendance of our members and there were some excellent questions asked during the Q & A portion. Please check out Friends of Medicare website <https://www.friendsofmedicare.org/> for more information and actions we can take regarding our concerns about the restructuring.

Pharmacare – Bill 64 was passed, and we are still waiting for guidelines from the federal government on how it will be implemented. This has been stalled due to the resignation of Prime Minister Trudeau. Until we have a new leader of the Liberals, things are not going to move forward.

Public Interest Alberta will be holding their Annual conference on March 27 and 28 at Barnett House in Edmonton. The theme is: Community Advocacy: Protecting the Public Good in Perilous Times. There will be workshops and keynote speakers. <https://www.pialberta.org/> for tickets.

Don't forget to register for our AGM April 16, 2025. The luncheon is always fantastic, and we have some wonderful entertainment following our business meeting. Please consider volunteering to be a part of our Board, it is vital that we fill our Board vacancies.

Respectfully submitted,
Linda Osborne
sunexdir@telus.net 780-920-3058



Notice by Nominating Committee of the Board of Directors

The nominating committee is seeking SUN members who would be interested in having their name, put forward for election to sit on the Board of Directors at the April 16, 2025, Annual General Meeting

Skills and Experience: A passion for seniors' issues; leadership or technical skills; marketing and promotions; As a member of the Board, a director acts in a position of trust and is responsible for the effective governance of the society.

Meetings: The SUN Board of Director's usually meets on the first Wednesday of each month via the zoom platform. Meetings commence at 10:00am and concludes at noon. (Meetings are not usually held in July or August)

Term: Directors are elected for a two-year term.

Benefits: To contribute to be part of the changes necessary to meet the dynamics of a growing and changing senior population within Alberta.

I cordially invite members of SUN society to consider volunteering as a board member. We anticipate having **three vacancies** and **urgently need volunteers** to fill these positions.

Thank you in advance for your consideration.

For further information or to put your name forward for election, please contact SUN Executive Director, Linda Osborne by Friday April 04, 2025

780-920-3058 sunexdir@telus.net Linda Osborne, SUN Executive Director

South Edmonton Chapter

A message to our chapter members

South Edmonton Chapter meetings are held at the Whitemud Public Library (4211 -106 St.) in the Program Room. On the third Friday of the month, no meetings are held during the months of April, July, August, and December. Registration is now at 2:15pm and the presentation is at 2:30 pm. We wish to thank the Edmonton Public Library and its staff for the support we receive. Also, we thank McDonalds 23rd Ave & 110th St for the complimentary coffee and snacks provided for each meeting.



Everyone is welcomed at our meetings, member or non-member.

South Chapter held an executive steering committee meeting on January 20, 2025.

One member of our executive resigned but two additional members were added on. Chapter executives assist at our events and attend our chapter planning meetings, which are usually held monthly. If you are interested in joining SUN or our chapter executive, please contact us, information is below.

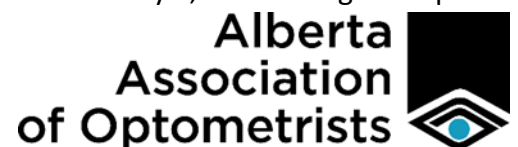
WHAT HAPPENED...

January 17, 2025 Our topic was "What to Know About Hearing Aids, Devices and Understanding Hearing Loss." Cincy Gordon, Program Director of Canadian Hard of Hearing Association was the guest speaker. She, was a childhood victim of hearing loss, as such, she provided personal experience about hearing loss. It was excellent presentation with plenty of handouts and good use of visual aids.



February 21, 2025 Topic: Optometrists Do More Than Eye Exams!

Speaker: Dr. Amal Ahmed Optometrists are a primary source for all your vision, eye health, eyewear needs, and are trained to evaluate, diagnose, prescribe treatment and medications. Learn about eye care and common eye health concerns for older adults, including dry eyes. Participants will receive brochures and resources on seniors' eye health, as well as an "Eye Healthy" cookbook. Hear about the February 1, 2025 changes in optometry coverage for Albertans. **Prevention is your best insurance policy!**



WHAT'S UPCOMING...

March 21, 2025 Topic: Self-Care for Caregivers

Sarah Pearson, Director of Mental Health Education, will discuss - what is self-care, recognizing exhaustion, self-care Domain Activity and Prioritizing what is most important. She will include a virtual presentation at this meeting to various senior groups, so that will expose SUN to a wider audience.

May 16, 2025 & June 20, 2025 Topic & Guest Speaker To Be Confirmed

Chair: Robert Price

780-250-7164 price4583@gmail.com

Annual General Meeting April 16, 2025

Seniors United Now Society - AGM will be held on Wednesday April 16, 2025

Santa Maria Goretti Centre 11050-90 Street NW Edmonton, Alberta

Doors open for Attendance 9:30 am Meeting Commences 10:00 am

Bob Layton and Shane Blakely Presentation 11:00 am – Luncheon @ noon

Pre-Registration and payment are required prior to April 04, 2025

Registration is available online via SUN website, Etransfer: unitenow@telus.net (access through your financial institution online banking), in-person at Chapter meetings or SUN office (with appointment) or via Canada Post mail.

Registration form is on Page 16 (Luncheon is included with Registration Fee)



Reprinted from SUNBURST 63 EVERSION

Advocacy Success!

In Late 2022 a SUN member wrote to SUN, they were shocked at what they had been forced to pay their medical practitioner for the required medical exam to renew their driver's license **\$200**. That communication set SUN on an advocacy path that started with a survey of seniors that was introduced in SUNBURST 58 April 2023 and online via our website. With over 200 responses, 55% of respondents stated they paid between **\$75 and \$150 for their exam and 9% paid more than \$150**.

SUN shared this information in May 2023 with:

Danielle Smith, Premier of Alberta - Rachel Notley, Leader of the Official Opposition - Jason Copping, Minister of Health & Jeremy Nixon, Minister of Seniors, Community and Social Services. No response was received, therefore SUN sent additional communications in June 2023. Finally, a response was received July 26, 2023, from Adriana LaGrange - Minister of Health stating "that Alberta Health is exploring options to reduce fees for seniors' driver medical exams based on their ability to pay". SUN responded in October 2023, stating "seniors are requesting that this fee be eliminated altogether". January 30th, 2024, SUN President - Wayne Sorenson & Executive Director Linda Osborne met with Dana Mackie – Assistant Deputy Minister - Seniors, Community and Social Services & Jasvinder Chana - Executive Director, Seniors Strategic Planning. Several topics were discussed including these fees.

Finally, it was announced that effective April 1, 2024,

Alberta seniors aged 65 and older are eligible to receive a 25% discount for medical exams and on personal registry services. (see below & page 6 for the details)

***While this was less than SUN was hoping for,
it is at least a step in the right direction.***

Please renew your membership, support our fundraising, donate and consider sharing our information with other seniors in your community.

Effective April 1, 2024, Alberta seniors aged 65 and older will be eligible to receive a 25% discount on personal registry services.

Overview: Services eligible for the seniors' discount include driver's licence renewals, passenger vehicle registrations, driver's abstracts, marriage licences and birth certificates.

The seniors' discount is a Government of Alberta initiative designed to make life more affordable for seniors.

Who is eligible: The seniors' discount is available to individuals aged 65 and over who reside in Alberta. To receive a discount on eligible services, you must be 65 or older on the date of purchase.

•The seniors' discount is available to seniors, and agents acting on behalf of a senior for motor vehicles and vital statistics services. The seniors' discount is available to seniors who are part of a group accessing a service (for example: joint vehicle registration). **How the discount will be processed:** The discount will be applied to eligible services at point of sale at any Alberta registry agent office. Seniors purchasing personal registry services online through MyAlberta eServices will also be able to access the discount, but not all services eligible for the discount are available online.

•For example: first-time driver's licence or ID card applications, first-time vehicle registration or vehicle transfers, address changes, or driver's licence reclassifications must be processed in person at a registry agent.

Continued on Page 6

Continued from Page 5 Effective April 1, 2024, Alberta seniors aged 65 and older will be eligible to receive a 25% discount on personal registry services.

Reimbursement for Driver's Medical Examinations

Seniors can receive 25% back on the cost of a driver's medical examination at any Alberta registry in a few simple steps.

1. Complete the exam at your physician's office and get a receipt that includes your name, service provided, date and physician's details (clinic, address, phone number) and the amount paid for the service.
2. Bring the receipt to your local registry office.
3. Upon receiving the receipt, a registry agent will verify eligibility, calculate the 25% discount, and issue a credit.
4. The credit will be processed, and you will be reimbursed the 25% discount in the form of a government-issued cheque which will be mailed to the address on your motor vehicles file within 10 business days.

The discount applies to driver's medical examinations completed on or after April 1, 2024, if a valid physician issued receipt is provided.

Restrictions

- The seniors' discount does not apply to corporate and business services, personal property services, commercial vehicle registrations or optional products such as personalized and specialty licence plates.
- Seniors' discounts will not be applied to services that are tied to punitive measures, or to enforcing traffic safety (for example: fines, ignition interlock and restricted licence applications).

Starting May 1, 2025, Alberta Parks is introducing a **camping fee discount** to make it more affordable for seniors to experience Alberta's natural beauty. Alberta residents who are 65 or older at time of purchase can receive 25% off camping fees at select campgrounds. To learn more, visit

<https://www.albertaparks.ca/seniordiscount/> These include over 140 front country campgrounds including individual, walk-in, and equestrian campsites. By targeting the discount at hidden gem campgrounds, we are encouraging affordable enjoyment of recreation opportunities across Alberta without increasing pressure at parks that usually have full capacity. The discount can be applied to select campsite bookings beginning on January 31, 2025, for May 1 arrivals and onwards. First-come, first-served arrivals will also have access to the discount May 1 and onwards at participating campgrounds. The discount applies to the camping fee and to fees for additional services, such as power, sewer, or water hook-ups, when included in the camping fee.

Eligibility:

The Alberta senior must be: 65 years of age or older at time of purchase be the primary occupant/account holder and be present at the time of check-in and throughout the entire stay. The senior must acknowledge the terms and conditions when reserving and/or registering for their campsite. Only one member of the camping party needs to be an Alberta senior to qualify for the discount. The senior is permitted the discount on a maximum of one campsite. This includes fees for additional camping accommodation units if they fit within the campsite. Proof of eligibility is required at time of arrival. Providing false information may result in cancellation of purchase. Accepted methods of identification are an Alberta Driver's License or Alberta Identification Card but may include other forms of government issued identification that verifies age and documentation no older than 30 days that verifies Alberta residency.

Exceptions:

The discount does not apply to: online reservation and amendment/change fees, backcountry campsites, seasonal camping, group area campsites or comfort camping, including William Watson Lodge and Campground, fees for passes (including Kananaskis Conservation Pass), tours, programming, memberships, and rentals, showers and firewood sold separately at campgrounds, concession and retail items, and other discounts (no stacking or combining with any other discounts is permitted).

How to Claim the Alberta Parks Camping Fee Discount for Alberta Seniors:

For online reservations, select "Alberta Seniors" under the Site Occupants section when you make your booking through Shop.Albertaparks.ca.

How-to guide.

For phone-in reservations, you will be asked to self-declare that you are an Alberta senior. At registration, you will be asked to show proof of eligibility. At locations with self-registration, you will be directed to self-declare and have proof of eligibility available during your stay.

North Edmonton Chapter

Quarterly Activity Summary

We continue to hold our meetings at Glengarry Community Hall, 13325 – 89 street, Edmonton. Registration begins at 1:00 p.m. and the meeting commences at 1:30 p.m. Our volunteers continue to step forward to arrange the seating requirements as well as the post meeting clean up requirements. If you have some computer skills, please step forward as we need a recording secretary. If you can help, contact Wayne Sorenson at 780-964-1142.

At each meeting, we host excellent guest speakers who discuss a variety of seniors topics. At the end of each meeting, we have a Save on Foods gift card door prize and a 50/50 draw. Everyone is welcome, bring a friend and enjoy the fellowship, free baked goods and tea and coffee. A very special thank you to Save on Foods located at 167 Ave. and 50th street for their donation of tasty treats for our meetings.



WHATS HAPPENED?

January 9, 2025

Topic: Getting to Know Greater Edmonton Foundation (GEF) Seniors Housing guest speaker Denise Roy-Popal, community supports manager for GEF delivered an excellent presentation. She informed us on what they do, types of accommodation offered, contact information, locations, and the eligibility, application process, wait times, rates and fees.

February 13, 2025

Topic: Seniors Coordinated Outreach Program Guest speaker Nancy Wang, from the Seniors Council, will inform us on 10 organizations that can refer seniors to services such as financial assistance, help with completing forms, home care, housing, social groups, housekeeping, snow removal, yard work, moving help and health issues.

WHATS UPCOMING?

March 13, 2025 Topic: Elder Abuse in Alberta Guest Speaker: Rachel Augustine Community Response Coordinator The Alberta Government estimated that 1 in 10 seniors may experience elder abuse. Do you know how to recognize and respond to it? This session offers a brief overview of elder abuse, highlights Edmonton's available resources, and provides tips on supporting a friend experiencing abuse. While the topic is sensitive, the focus is on offering guidance and support. Bring your questions and join this informative discussion on such an important topic.

May 08, 2025 Topic: Alberta Motor Association An AMA representative will discuss the services they provide and actions that seniors can take to help reduce premiums on vehicle, home and travel insurance. Once again bring a friend and bring your questions and join in on the informative discussions.

June 13, 2025

Chapter Member Social – Details forthcoming

6 Senior Smiles

1) As I've grown older, I've learned that pleasing everyone is impossible but annoying everyone is a piece of cake. 2) I'm responsible for what I say, not what you understand. 3) As I watch this generation try and rewrite our history, I'm sure of one thing: It will be misspelled and have no punctuation. 4) I haven't gotten anything done today. I've been in the Produce Department trying to open this stupid plastic bag. 5) Hard to believe I once had a phone attached to a wall, and when it rang, I picked it up without knowing who was calling. 6) There is no such thing as a grouchy old person. The truth is that once you get old, you stop being polite and start being honest.



Sherwood Park / Strathcona County Chapter (SPSC)**Quarterly Activity Summary**

Chapter meetings are held on the 3rd Tuesday of each month except April, July, August, and December. Registration at 1:00p.m. Meetings commence at 1:30pm and are held at Bethel Lutheran Church located at 298 Bethel Drive, Sherwood Park, which is fully accessible. Members and non-members are welcome. Our presenters answer many questions during and after their presentations and are thanked with an appreciation gift. ***A special thank you to the Sherwood Park Real Canadian Superstore for supplying us for cookies***

**What's Happened?**

January 21, 2025 Topic: What kind of Supports and Services are needed for Seniors in Strathcona County?

Presenter: Haidong Liam, PhD MA, B.R.M.C.D Gerontologist and Executive Director of WESeniors Strathcona

Highlights of Dr. Liang's presentation are: He recommends we use a hand gripper and resistance training to strengthen our muscles. We can have unexpected changes (loss of driver's license, broken hip, other health issues, etc.) that happen in our life at any time, and we suddenly need to determine how to deal with the situation which can be difficult and stressful. We watched the first 3 minutes of an 11 minute Ted Talk called "A Shift in Thinking" [youtube.com/watch?v=mcYPiQGyZbM](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mcYPiQGyZbM) It shows how important it is to be out and talking to people vs. hiding at home. You need to belong and not just blend in.



Social isolation is the number 1 issue as one in four people are impacted. Based on the 2024 census, Strathcona County has about 21% of residents aged 65 and up, 28% age 60 and up and 34% age 55 and up. We need to have age friendly facilities and activities available for all seniors in the county that span age groups, physical health states and mental health states. We have not seen much public engagement in the last 4 years and need to approach all levels of government with questions. The West End Seniors in Edmonton is a hub for socializing, recreation, outreach, research, information sharing, technology and volunteering that keeps seniors of all kinds active and engaged. There are some inter-generational programs. It pays for the operating expenses through various grants and generation of income by renting out the facilities.

February 18, 2025 Topic: Estate planning - Planning for tomorrow, today

Presenter: Vincenzo Marozzi - Investment Advisor & Financial Planner - RBC Dominion Securities

Common elements of an estate plan: Creating a Will, ensuring all adult family members have an up-to-date Power of Attorney, evaluating life insurance coverage, Reviewing of ownership structures (i.e., which assets will pass through versus outside your estate), Updating beneficiary designations, Planning for taxes at death, Evaluating advanced opportunities, such as the use of trusts Considering charitable giving, Making pre-planned funeral arrangements.

**WHATS UPCOMING?**

March 18, 2025 Topic: Continuing Care Home Care Services

Presenter: Lisa Nielsen - Program Manager – AHS Suburban/Rural East Home Care

How we can help keep our clients safe and Independent in their homes as long as possible. Who are we? Who do we Serve? What are our Services? How are we Accessed?



May 20, 2025 Topic: Pharmacist and Aids to Daily Living –Tips for SENIORS

Presenter: Huy Luong Pharmacist and Ms MacDonald Synergy Pharmacy Sh. Pk.

SUN continues to work for you.

Please consider volunteering for our chapter, we need YOU!

Report respectfully submitted by: Denis Beaudry

Join us!

We welcome your wisdom, experience, and enthusiasm!



Sherwood Park / Strathcona County Chapter (SPSC)

Continued from Page 8

What's Happening: Advocacy for Strathcona Seniors Centre (ASC)**Next steps – Moving Forward****Goal: Becoming a Board, becoming a Non-Profit Society – Provincially, and seeking Charitable status, federally.**

November 23, 2024 – Our committee members attended a morning workshop on Governance and Healthy Organizations, with David Feldman. The information presented provided us with the steps and tools to look at the basics of establishing a Board.

December 10, 2024 – We attended Strathcona County - Family and Community Services (FCS) Presentation on Healthy Living at the Agora. FCS shared the results of the finalized version of the Healthy Aging Survey.

January 08, 2025 – ASC members met to work on our organizational values, so we have common groundwork, moving forward, establishing our Vision & Mission.

January 17, 2025 – ASC members met once more to review and reassess our organizational values, coming up with a document which we can present to Council & Administration when we meet.

February 05, 2025 – ASC members meeting – finalizing our report to present to Council & Administration.

February 14, 2025 – ASC members meeting with Mayor, Councillors, Administration & FCS members for the purpose of beginning the process of planning and design for our Seniors Centre.

WHATS UPCOMING?

May 2025 – ASC members will attend a 2-day workshop with David Feldman on Establishing Bylaws for our Board.

Thank you to SUN and all seniors for supporting us – we cannot do this work without you!

Respectfully submitted by Claudette McLean

Join us! We welcome your wisdom, experience, and enthusiasm!

**Our next Cash Raffle is:****"It's a Chili Day"**

~~February 27~~ March 31, 2025

License #715981



**DATE
EXTENDED**

Join our growing list of SUN winners!

See page 15 for ticket order form

purchase online:

www.seniorsunitednow.com

Tickets \$5.00 each 5 Tickets \$10.00 20 tickets \$20.00

Please consider supporting SUN's critical fundraising.

CASH RAFFLE – Winners**"Halloween Hoot"**

October 31, 2024

License #700801



Congratulations to SUN members:

R. Garvey Edmonton, AB ticket #155

C. Otto Edmonton, AB Ticket #362

**Thanks to all members for supporting
SUN's critical fundraising by
purchasing tickets!**

Senior Foot Care: Caring for Feet as You Age

The average person takes 8,000 to 10,000 steps a day for a lifetime walking average of 115,000 miles, or more than 4 trips around the earth.



Many older adults get frequent checkups, exercise regularly, and in general try to take good care of themselves, but one aspect of their health that they (and for that matter, younger people) frequently neglect is good foot care. Foot injury, neglect, and disease are major factors contributing to mobility, or lack thereof, in older adults. In one study, 71% of respondents aged 65 or older reported foot pain and problems, yet only 39% of them had sought medical advice and only 26% of them believe their foot problems were medical conditions. Senior adults tend to experience more problems with their feet than younger adults simply because they have used them for longer. Women are four times more likely than men to have foot problems, probably because of the preponderance of high heels. Other conditions, such as diabetes and poor circulation can also affect foot health. Proper footcare is crucial for seniors to maintain an active and healthy lifestyle. Neglecting foot health can lead to serious issues such as infections, balance problems, and decreased mobility. If you have diabetes, it's important to take care of your feet. Diabetes can cause nerve damage that makes it hard to tell if you have a foot injury. When foot injuries go unnoticed, they can worsen and become infected, sometimes leading to hospitalization or even amputation.

Here are some essential tips for seniors to ensure your feet remain in good condition.

Hygiene: Maintaining good foot hygiene is essential. Seniors should wash their feet daily with warm water and mild soap, making sure to dry them thoroughly, especially between the toes. Moisturize the feet regularly to prevent dryness and cracking but avoid applying lotion between the toes to reduce the risk of fungal infections.

Regular Inspections: Seniors should inspect their feet daily for any signs of problems. Look for cuts, bruises, blisters, swelling, or any changes in color or temperature. Use a mirror or ask a family member for help if bending over is difficult. Early detection of issues can prevent more serious complications.

Manage Medical Conditions: Chronic conditions such as diabetes, arthritis, and poor circulation can significantly impact foot health. Seniors with these conditions should have regular check-ups with their healthcare providers and follow recommended foot care routines. Diabetics, in particular, need to pay special attention to their feet, as they are at higher risk for foot ulcers and infections.

Professional Care: Get regular exams. Your health care provider should examine your feet at least once a year. ***Taking off your shoes and socks while you wait for the doctor can be a helpful reminder.*** Regular visits to a podiatrist are beneficial for seniors. A podiatrist can provide professional care, address specific foot problems, and offer advice tailored to individual needs. They can also recommend orthotic devices if necessary to improve foot function and alleviate pain.

Nail Care: Proper nail care is important to avoid problems like ingrown toenails or fungal infections. Seniors should trim their toenails straight across and file the edges to prevent them from becoming too sharp. If it's difficult to reach the toes, a podiatrist can help with regular nail trimming. See a doctor or podiatrist for corn and callus removal. Don't use chemical products or try to cut them yourself. Tell your provider if have diabetes.

Exercise: Regular exercise helps maintain foot strength, flexibility, and circulation. Simple activities like walking, stretching, and foot exercises can improve overall foot health and prevent problems like stiffness and poor circulation. Seniors should consult with a healthcare provider before starting any new exercise regimen.

Proper Footwear: Wearing appropriate shoes is vital for foot health. Seniors should choose shoes that provide adequate support, cushioning, and room for the toes. Avoid high heels, narrow shoes, or shoes with slippery soles. Shoes with Velcro straps or elastic laces are often easier to manage than traditional laces. It's also important to wear socks made of breathable materials and to change them daily. Don't wear socks that have been mended or have holes. Padded athletic socks can give extra protection. Never walk barefoot, not even indoors. Wear comfortable shoes that fit well and protect your feet. Check inside your shoes before wearing them. Make sure the lining is smooth and there are no objects inside. Don't wear sandals with toe straps, and don't wear shoes without socks. Buy shoes that are comfortable at the time of purchase. Wear new shoes for only 1 hour indoors the first day. Check your feet for blisters and slowly increase the wearing time each day.

Protect your feet from heat and cold. Wear shoes at the beach and on hot pavement. Test bath water with your hand to be sure it isn't too hot. Never use hot water bottles, heating pads, or electric blankets. If your feet feel cold at night, wear socks.

Protect your circulation: Put your feet up when you sit. Wiggle your toes and flex your feet up and down from time to time during the day. Don't cross your legs for long periods of time.

Except of Letter to Auditor General - January 08, 2025

Subject: Alberta Public Sector Pension Plans - Coordinated Pension Option

On behalf of our SUN Board of Directors, we are pleased to see on your website that you offer the opportunity to suggest an audit for your office to investigate. Your website also states that your mandate is to “monitor and evaluate the performances and sustainability of a number of public service pension plans” which includes the Local Authorities Pension Plan (LAPP) and the Public Service Pension Plan (PSPP).

During Premier Klein’s public employee layoffs, the Coordinated Pension option was implemented to assist retiree’s with increasing their pension between the age of 55 to 65. At age 65 the retiree had their pension reduced to pay back the amount that they received. It was explained to the retirees that it was just like paying back a loan and at age 72 the full payment will be made. However, it was not fully explained to some of them that if they live beyond age 72, deductions will be taken from their pension cheques until the day they die.

We have received feedback from many pensioners that this plan was not properly communicated to them and some have paid back, in some instances over \$150,000 above the original amount that they received.

In a letter dated Oct,2019, written by Phil Rivard, Vice President, Pension Policy and Funding LAPP Corporation he states “Given the number of individuals who have expressed difficulties understanding the impacts of Coordination, we are likely to recommend to the Board to eliminate the Coordination feature of LAPP members who have yet to retire”. His comments also indicates that the roll out of the program had some deficient components. Also, the retirees’ employers may not have explained the program properly, which lead to the misunderstanding of the payback program.

It is interesting to note that some time ago, on the LAPP website they explain why they have discontinued the Coordinated Option (2021). They do state “following several years of complaints from members who may not have understood the implications properly, led to their decision”. Sheri Wright, Vice-President of stakeholder relations and communication at LAPP says the “while confusion is the #1 concern expressed by members”, she suspects there are many more who regret their decision yet remain silent.

When this coordinated program was implemented, through correspondence, Hon. Ron Liepert indicated that the program was to be cost neutral. We are requesting if your office can indeed indicate if this is true. Our concern is pensioners who are still having their pensions reduced, even though they have paid over and above the amount that they owed have contributed far more than the pension plan lost as a result of pensioners dying before their loan was ever recovered. If this is case then this program was certainly not cost neutral but we have been unable to acquire this information.

We are hopeful that you can audit this situation, and we look forward to your response.

Wayne Sorenson - President, Seniors United Now

AGM VOLUNTEERS NEEDED April 16, 2025

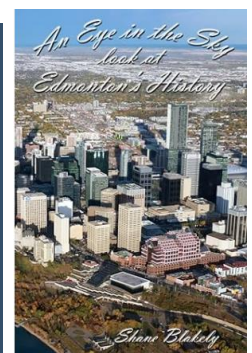
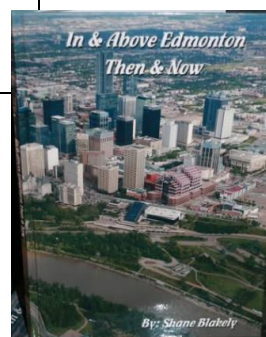
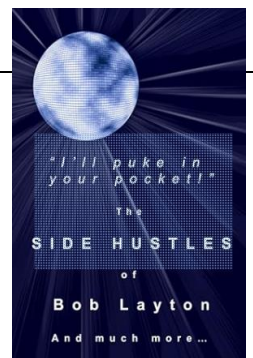
Registration Tables – six volunteers
50-50 Sales – Mobility needed – two volunteers
Set - up – four volunteers
Take – down – four volunteers

To Volunteer

Email Unitenow@telus.net or visit our SUN website
[Volunteer](#) | [Seniors United Now](#) | [Alberta](#)



April 16, 2025
Be sure to join us for some
great entertainment –
thanks to:
**Bob Layton and
Shane Blakely**



Our health care system isn't broken, it's being dismantled

In the past year, 72 per cent of Albertans reported a decline in their health care quality. Given our province's ever-increasing surgical wait times, routine emergency room closures, and family doctor shortage, this finding doesn't come as a surprise but rather supports a common sentiment across Alberta — that our health care system is broken.

Behind this statement and the real frustrations fueling it, however, is a harsher truth. Our public system isn't failing to deliver due to incompetent leadership; it is being intentionally dismantled by our provincial government. Through destructive restructuring and an agenda of privatization, we are losing care services and frontline workers when we need them most. Rather than accepting this treatment, however, we can demand better from our government and rebuild our health care.

Alberta's public health care system is in crisis. But the crisis is a lack of capacity and workforce. Chronic underinvestment has left us with a system ill-equipped and ill-staffed to address the medical needs of our growing population. Over 700,000 Albertans do not have a family doctor, forcing them to rely on Emergency Rooms for primary care. Not only has this caused ER wait times to skyrocket but, due to short-staffing, many communities are experiencing severe service cuts and closures.

In spite of record investment in private surgical centers, wait times for surgical operations continue to surge, with Albertans waiting a total of 92 weeks — over a year and a half — on average to receive a consult and knee replacement, well above recommended wait times. Instead of fixing these unacceptable outcomes, the Alberta government is spearheading an unnecessary and wasteful restructuring of Alberta Health Services (AHS) that is only making them worse. Breaking apart our existing system isn't solving our problems, it is only fueling chaos, dividing up the workforce, and creating openings for private, for-profit operators to take over parts of the system. The government is prioritizing for-profit interests as their so-called solution, repeatedly contracting out public services to private providers and approving delivery models that rely on private clinics. Increased privatization is diverting public dollars away from public services, leading to increased staff burnout, service delays, and reduced capacity in our hospitals.

Fortunately, we can stop this destruction. There is an alternative path forward, one where we rebuild our health care system and ensure every Albertan receives the care they deserve. To begin, the government must end the destructive restructuring and privatization schemes currently underway. Then, we must expand our care capacity by investing in our care services, ensuring that public resources remain in the public system and not the pockets of for-profit companies. Finally, we must address the short staffing crisis by developing a workforce plan. A plan that first prioritizes retention of our skilled health care professionals, while looking ahead to recruitment and training. By stabilizing the system, rather than undermining it, we can ensure high-quality care and rebuild a system that frontline workers and Albertans can depend upon. Take action now.

Learn more: www.rebuildourhealthcare.ca

Chris Gallaway - Executive Director



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Get your quote today with group ID code ASUNS

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SUN is offering every current SUN member the opportunity to gift a **FREE** 6-month membership to another senior. How do you do this? Complete the Membership gift form and send it to the SUN admin office and we will do all the rest.

belairdirect.



Win 1 of 12 cash prizes of \$2,500*

Simply scan the QR code and enter for your chance to win!

belairdirect.com/2500prize



SUN MEMBERSHIP GIFT valid – March – June 2025

Gift Memberships will be due for renewal November 2025

Current Member Name: _____ **Membership#** _____

Gift Membership details:

Name(s): _____

Address: _____

Phone # _____ **Email** _____

Year of Birth: _____ **If available (used for SUN demographics only will not be shared)** **For Office USE:** _____

Message from your Membership Coordinator

Membership is the only way SUN has to fund the programs and materials we provide for our members. It is a very **important** aspect of running our advocacy program. If we are to continue to be the Voice of Seniors in Alberta, we need you to renew your memberships, invite your friends to our Chapter meetings, purchase our 50/50 tickets and of course volunteer and support our events.

Join us on up-to-date information on our Facebook page. You will find updates on upcoming Chapter events and more. If you have a Facebook page search Seniors United Now and **join our page**, invite your friends.

We will be planning more ZOOM presentations in 2025. Stay tuned to our webpage, Facebook, email updates and of course our SUNBURST newsletters.

I am preparing for our Annual General Meeting April 16, 2025 and I am looking for table sponsors. If you have any suggestions of folks who would like to attend, please let me know. I am also collecting door prizes for our members.

If you have any ideas on how to increase our membership, I would be open to hearing from you. You can reach me by email at suncoord@telus.net.

Chapters need your support to keep running so consider volunteering at their meetings. Membership has its rewards with benefits of new friendships, information and support.

I look forward to working for you for a better SUN.

Deborah Wilson
Membership Coordinator



PEACE OF MIND
CONCIERGE

EXPERT SENIORS SUPPORT FOR YOU AND YOUR FAMILY

Tammy Lautner, RSW
Seniors Supports
Specialist/Caregiver Consultant

Explore Housing Options with Ease:
We will take the work out of finding suitable housing that fits your needs.

Master the Healthcare System:
Receive clear, expert guidance to navigate the complex healthcare landscape with confidence.

Compassionate Family Assistance:
Let's work together to find personalized solutions for caring for your senior family member.

Call or email Tammy Lautner:
780-720-3035
info@peacemindconcierge.com

SENIORS UNITED NOW - CASINO VOLUNTEERS NEEDED

4TH Quarter 2025 (date will be advised in May 2025)

Location: Century Casino 13103 Fort Road

Volunteer Positions can be for one or both days. *Although a volunteer may only do one role during the event (e.g. volunteers cannot be a cashier one day and a chip runner the next day)

Positions: Day General Manager, Night GM, Day Banker, Night Banker, Day Cashier(2), Night Cashier(2), Day Chip Runner(2), Night Chip Runner
Count Room 11:00PM - 3:30 AM

Count Room Supervisor (1) Count Room Worker (5)

Job Descriptions: General Manager - supervise all aspects of the casino - works closely with the casino facility games manager

Banker - Supervise the cash cage - Document all transactions

Cashier - Cash Handling experience is **strongly advised** - Redeems player's chips for cash, Interaction with the players

Chip Runner (mobility required) - Minimal amount of computer input is required - A courier (runner) for chip orders - Participates in the opening and closing of games tables.

Count Room Staff - Open and sorts cash from drop Boxes - Runs cash through money machines, amalgamates each drop box - **Count Room Supervisor** is required to input count from each drop box in computer.

For more info or to volunteer email: unitenow@telus.net or visit our SUN website [Volunteer](#) | [Seniors United Now](#) | [Alberta](#)

Please renew your membership, support our fundraising, donate and volunteer if you are able.

It's a Chili Day

Name(s): _____

Address: _____

Phone # _____ For Office USE: _____

Email _____
(please print)

Individual Tickets: _____ Tickets \$5.00 each \$ _____ (40 available)

5 tickets \$10.00 _____ Sets \$10.00 each \$ _____ (60 sets available)

20 tickets \$20.00 _____ Sets \$20.00 each \$ _____ (110 sets available)

Draw Date: ~~February 27, 2025~~

March 31, 2025

License #715981

Please make your cheque
payable to SUN**RAFFLE RULES**

- 1) Raffle tickets must not be sold to a person under the age of 18 years. Purchasers must be Alberta residents.
- 2) The purchase price of each ticket shall be: \$5.00 each OR 5 tickets \$10.00 OR 20 tickets \$20.00
- 3) To be eligible for draws, the ticket order and purchase amount must be received in SUN office by 10:00am, March 31, 2025
- 4) The prize payout shall be as follows:
1st prize 30% of the gross ticket sale revenue
2nd prize 20% of the gross ticket sale revenue
- 5) The draw(s) shall be made at the SUN office: #37 2016 Sherwood Drive, Sherwood Park, AB T8A3X3 prior to 3pm, March 31, 2025
- 6) The winning ticket buyers shall be notified by telephone; their names will be publicized in the next newsletter & on the SUN website. The winning ticket buyers will be awarded the prize via cheque drawn on SUN.
- 7) In the event of any concern or dispute regarding this raffle, please contact Lynn Penner at the SUN administration office. 780-449-1816
- 8) Raffle tickets are official when payment is received & numbers issued by the sun raffle chairman.
- 9) Your Ticket numbers are available by contacting the SUN office

**SUN MEMBERSHIP Renewal / Donation Jan – Mar 2025**Individual: ☐ \$25 per year ☐ \$50 2 years Lifetime: ☐ \$200Joint: ☐ \$40 per year ☐ \$80 2 years Lifetime: ☐ \$300

Donation in addition to membership dues

☐ \$5 ☐ \$10 ☐ \$15 ☐ \$20 ☐ \$25 ☐ other \$ _____

Renewal \$ _____ Donation \$ _____ Raffle \$ _____ AGM \$ _____

Please make cheque payable to Seniors United Now

Signed Cheque(s) enclosed Chq# _____ Total \$ _____

Membership # _____ (see Back Page)

Joint Member (if applicable) Membership # _____

☐ YES - replace my membership card☐ YES - replace my membership card

(Please attach a stamped self-addressed stamped envelope if you are requesting a replacement card)

Name: _____

Name: _____

Year of Birth: _____ (used for SUN demographics only)

Year of Birth: _____ (used for SUN demographics only)

Address: _____

(If different from mailing label on reverse)

Renew your membership online! SUN uses the PayPal system, for secure online renewals & donations

Etransfer may also be used for membership payments and donations. unitenow@telus.net

Phone: _____ Email: _____ (send me electronic SUN information)

(Please print clearly)

☐ YES – I am interested in volunteering, please contact me.

Thank-You for your prompt renewal. Renewals & donations may also be made by Etransfer to unitenow@telus.net or online via our website

AGM REGISTRATIONOnline registration available visit: www.seniorsunitednow.com

Alberta Seniors United Now Society – April 16, 2025

Name(s): _____

Membership: # _____ # _____ Phone: _____

Email: _____

Pre-registration Tickets: \$10 per individual Current Member \$30 per non-member
AT THE DOOR TICKETS \$15 per individual Current Member \$35 per non-member
Ticket price includes admission - light lunch* & refreshments.

*If you have dietary restrictions, please advise the admin office

(Registration tickets will be held for pick-up at AGM pre-paid registration table)

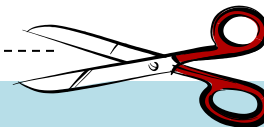
PAYMENT OPTIONS:**Online:** visit our website homepage See AGM notice click “Buy Now” Button**Etransfer:** unitenow@telus.net**Mail:** Seniors United Now # 37 - 2016 Sherwood Drive, Sherwood Park, AB T8A 3X3

#of Tickets _____ Amount: \$ _____ Cheque# _____ Registration deadline April 04, 2025

Pre-registration is required to facilitate planning of seating, lunch, and refreshments**Rules of Sudoku**

There are three Sudoku rules: Firstly, each row must contain the numbers 1-9 exactly once each. Secondly, each column must contain the numbers 1-9 exactly once each. Lastly, each 3x3 box must contain the numbers 1-9 exactly once each. That's it!

			5	7	2	1	3	6
	5	2						7
								5
	7		6		1	5		
5			9					
2				8	5		6	4
4	1		3	6				
6						7	4	
			4		9	6		3



Thank-you for being a SUN member,
 your membership information is
 available by contacting the SUN
 Administration office unitenow@telus.net

**Dan Aykroyd, actor and writer**

“Being Canadian really does mean always having to say: ‘I’m sorry.’ But I haven’t yet figured out why we do this. Perhaps Canadians apologize all the time because we live in a country that has so much more going for it than almost any other place on the planet, and it makes us feel a little guilty.”